

WMC IPTV

User Manual

Created and developed by Boxcar32

Windows Media Center IPTV / Live TV Integration

WMC IPTV lets Windows Media Center tune modern IPTV/live-TV sources through virtual HDHomeRun tuners while preserving the normal WMC guide and channel-tuning experience.

Tested Development Environment

Operating system: Windows 11 (OS Build 26200)

Windows Media Center: Garyan2's Windows Media Center installation

Tested WMC assembly: mcepg.dll - Assembly Version 6.3.0.0

Other community WMC installations may contain different Media Center assembly versions. Windows 7 support is currently under development/testing.

1. IMPORTANT - Requirements Before Installing WMC IPTV

Do not run WMC IPTV channel installation until the HDHomeRun Windows components and Windows Media Center TV Signal Setup have been completed. The current WMC IPTV virtual tuner design presents the tuners to WMC as DVB-T tuners. The WMC channel injector therefore expects WMC to already contain a scanned DVB-T lineup.

A. Install the Silicondust HDHomeRun Windows software

Download the official HDHomeRun Windows software from Silicondust:

<https://www.silicondust.com/support/downloads.html>

On the Silicondust download page, use **HDHomeRun Other Software for Windows**. The Windows package includes components used by older third-party TV/PVR software, including the Windows BDA drivers. Windows Media Center uses BDA tuner drivers to see HDHomeRun-compatible tuners.

Install the HDHomeRun Windows software. After installation, run **HDHomeRun Setup (hdhomerun_setup.exe)**. The setup utility is also useful for confirming that HDHomeRun-compatible tuner devices are visible to Windows.

B. Start the WMC IPTV virtual tuner / HDHRProxy environment

WMC must be able to discover the WMC IPTV virtual HDHomeRun tuner before TV Signal Setup can create the required lineup. WMC IPTV uses HDHRProxyIPTV to present virtual HDHomeRun tuners to Windows Media Center.

C. Configure Windows Media Center for DVB-T

Open Windows Media Center and go to:

Tasks -> Settings -> TV -> TV Signal -> Set Up TV Signal

For the current WMC IPTV DVB-T configuration, use the following tested setup:

Setting	Tested value
Country / Region	France
Postal Code	80005
Tuner type	DVB-T / Digital Antenna
Expected result	WMC detects/configures the virtual HDHomeRun tuners

Why France / 80005?

This is a **WMC IPTV-specific setup choice**, not a Silicondust recommendation. The current virtual tuner configuration is DVB-T. Selecting a DVB-T country/region allows WMC to create the type of scanned digital-antenna lineup that the current WMC IPTV channel injector uses. France with postal code 80005 is the configuration used for the tested WMC IPTV environment.

Complete TV Signal Setup all the way to the end. Do not stop after tuner detection. WMC must save the tuner configuration and create the scanned DVB-T lineup.

If WMC IPTV later reports **No DVB-T scanned lineup found**, return to WMC TV Signal Setup and verify that the virtual tuners were detected and that setup was completed.

2. What WMC IPTV Does

WMC talks to virtual HDHomeRun tuners supplied by HDHRProxyIPTV. The universal bridge then routes the selected channel to the appropriate source handler and supplies WMC with a compatible MPEG-TS stream.

Normal tuning path:

WMC -> HDHRProxyIPTV -> Universal Bridge (port 5590) -> source handler -> MPEG-TS -> WMC

Supported source tags

M3U source tag	Purpose
wmc-source="yttv"	YouTube TV through CC4C / Chrome
wmc-source="frndly"	Frndly TV
wmc-source="pluto"	Pluto / FAST streams
wmc-source="webcam"	YouTube Live cameras or direct webcam streams
wmc-source="local"	Local HDHomeRun streams
wmc-source="direct"	Direct HLS / compatible stream URLs

3. M3U Input Format

Each channel uses a standard #EXTINF line followed by its source URL. WMC IPTV uses the wmc-source tag to select the correct source handler.

Example - YouTube TV

```
#EXTINF:-1 tvg-id="example.id" tvg-chno="3101" wmc-source="yttv",Example Channel  
https://tv.youtube.com/watch/qfvxxxxx
```

The channel display name belongs after the comma. The source URL belongs on the following line.

4. WMC IPTV Stage 1

After the HDHomeRun software and WMC TV Signal Setup prerequisites are complete, run WMC IPTV Setup.exe as administrator. Stage 1 asks for the tagged M3U playlist, builds source configuration and the HDHRProxyIPTV mapping, starts the runtime components, and adds the M3U channels to Windows Media Center.

The distribution includes GaRyan2.Utilities.dll and GaRyan2.WmcUtilities.dll with permission from their creator, Garyan2.

Runtime ports

5589 - CC4C

5590 - WMC IPTV universal bridge

5. Stage 2 - EPG123 Guide Mapping

Stage 2 matches WMC IPTV channels against the EPG123 MXF export and links matching WMC channels to guide listings. Stage 2 is for guide mapping; it is not required simply to prove that an installed channel can tune and play.

6. WMC Version Compatibility

WMC IPTV was developed and tested on **Windows 11 (OS Build 26200)** using **Garyan2's Windows Media Center installation**. The tested development environment contains **mcepg.dll Assembly Version 6.3.0.0**.

Community WMC distributions can contain different Media Center assembly versions. The tested version above describes the development system and should not be assumed to apply to every Garyan2 or other community WMC installation.

If a helper reports an mcepg.dll or mcstore.dll load/version error, determine the assembly version installed on that computer. Do not replace WMC system DLLs merely to satisfy an assembly-version error.

Windows 7 support is currently under development/testing.

7. Troubleshooting

No DVB-T scanned lineup found

This means the WMC channel injector opened the WMC database but could not find the DVB-T scanned lineup it needs. Verify that the Silicondust HDHomeRun Windows/BDA software is installed, the virtual tuner is discoverable, and WMC TV Signal Setup was completed using the DVB-T configuration described in Section 1.

mcepg.dll or mcstore.dll load/version error

This indicates a WMC assembly compatibility issue, not an M3U formatting problem. Record the installed assembly version rather than replacing WMC system DLLs.

Black screen / channel does not play

Confirm HDHRProxyIPTV is running, the universal bridge is listening on port 5590, and CC4C is listening on port 5589 when a YouTube TV channel is used.

8. Credits and Acknowledgements

WMC IPTV

Created and developed by **Boxcar32**.

Garyan2

GaRyan2.Utilities.dll and GaRyan2.WmcUtilities.dll were created by Garyan2 and are included and redistributed with permission. WMC IPTV gratefully acknowledges Garyan2's contributions to the Windows Media Center community.

Kévin Chalet

WMC IPTV acknowledges Kévin Chalet for his published work documenting HDHomeRun BDA integration with HDHRProxyIPTV and Windows Media Center, including virtual tuner configuration and programmatic channel injection.

Reference article:

Connecting Windows Media Center to Tvheadend with HDHRProxyIPTV: an alternative to DVBLink

These acknowledgements do not imply authorship or endorsement of WMC IPTV by the credited parties.

Silicondust / HDHomeRun

HDHomeRun is a registered trademark of Silicondust USA Inc. WMC IPTV users should obtain the official Windows HDHomeRun software from Silicondust's download page.

Silicondust HDHomeRun Downloads